

RESEARCH STUDY - FEBRUARY 2026

AI FOR AMERICANS FIRST

*AI Protectionism, Energy and Semiconductors:
US/Europe Divergence Trajectories 2024-2030*

Integrated Geostrategic and Economic Analysis - ANNEX D - RESEARCH NOTE

**76.9% of global operational AI
compute = USA**

**1.59x energy cost EU/US (PPP-
adjusted)**

**3.46:1 CACI US/EU ratio (Power
Mode)**

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ANNEX D - RESEARCH NOTE

Cognitive Density Economy and Market Structuring: An Economic Intelligence Analysis of the Huang Doctrine on AI Token Consumption

This annex presents the March 2026 research note on the cognitive density economy, written following the statement by Jensen Huang (CEO of NVIDIA) on March 20: 'If an engineer paid \$500,000 does not consume at least \$250,000 of AI tokens per year, I would be deeply alarmed.' The note proposes an economic intelligence analysis of this statement, placing it in the context of NVIDIA's dominant market position (80% share) and the American protectionist architecture documented in the CACI Power Mode index (3.46:1 US/EU ratio). The analysis demonstrates that the prescription of massive token consumption is more about market structuring than managerial advice.

D.1 Context: A High-Impact Statement

On March 20, 2026, at the San Jose GTC, Jensen Huang stated that an engineer earning \$500,000 who doesn't spend at least \$250,000 on AI tokens would be a cause for alarm. He confirmed NVIDIA is attempting to spend \$2 billion on tokens for its own engineering team.

Professional reception focused almost exclusively on the managerial dimension: productivity through intensive AI use. This note proposes a different reading based on economic intelligence.

D.2 Analytical Framework: Who is Speaking?

The first reflex in economic intelligence is to identify the speaker's structural position. Jensen Huang is the CEO of NVIDIA, the world's leading supplier of AI accelerators (80% market share). NVIDIA is the primary beneficiary of increased token consumption worldwide.

Therefore, the 'consume half your salary in tokens' directive is not a neutral managerial tip; it is a market-structuring act. Every dollar spent on tokens generates demand for compute executed on NVIDIA hardware.

D.5 Cognitive Density Economy: From Managerial to Geostrategic Meaning

Cognitive density refers not just to individual productivity, but to a new global power regime. A nation's wealth is increasingly measured by its capacity to transform compute into reliable, verifiable, and sovereign results.

This is formalized by the CACI Power Mode ($F^{0.40} \times L^{0.20} \times R^{0.15} / E^{0.25}$). On the April 2026 snapshot, the US/EU CACI ratio stands at 3.46:1, driven by a 17.6:1 raw operational compute gap and a 1.59x energy cost advantage for the US.

D.7 Conclusion

The Huang doctrine on cognitive density should be read not as a universal productivity mandate, but as a signal of market structuring whose structural beneficiaries (NVIDIA, US hyperscalers) are identified. For France and Europe, the goal is not technological autarky, but the capacity to choose: mastering the ratio between produced value and accepted dependence.

Table D.1. Empirical data on GenAI ROI in enterprises (2025-2026).

Source: Author's compilation from independent surveys.

Source	Year	Main Finding
MIT NANDA 'The GenAI Divide'	2025	95% of GenAI projects in enterprises produced no measurable P&L impact
PwC CEO Survey (Davos)	2026	56% of CEOs state AI has not produced significant benefits
Gartner	2025	60% of AI projects abandoned by end of 2026 due to non-AI-ready data

Notes

1. Jensen Huang, All-In Podcast, March 20, 2026.
2. NVIDIA Market Share: 80% (SIA, McKinsey).

3. CACI Power Mode ratio US/EU: 3.46:1 (Snapshot April 2026).

4. MIT NADA 'The GenAI Divide' (2025).

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